

Knowledge Base: what each role can do

The Knowledge Base is HARI's HR document library. It is also the assistant's source of truth: `/chat` answers handbook questions by retrieving these same documents, through the same query, under the same access rules. There is no second copy of the content and no second set of permissions.

This guide demonstrates what the four roles can actually do with it. Every screenshot was taken from a running instance against the seeded demo data, signed in as the demo account named in the caption.

The short version

	Employee	Manager	HR Admin	Super Admin
Collections visible in the reader	2	3	4	4
Published articles readable	8	9	10	10
Create, edit, publish, archive	no	no	yes	yes
Decide what the assistant may use	no	no	no	yes

Two things in that table are worth stating plainly, because they are easy to assume otherwise. HR Admin and Super Admin read exactly the same content; the only thing that separates them is the assistant-access policy. And a Manager is not an administrator: the extra collection they see is a reading permission, not an editing one.

Three tiers, one rule

Every document carries one of three access tiers. A role's tier list is derived from what that role may already see in the employee directory, so the library cannot drift away from the rest of the app.

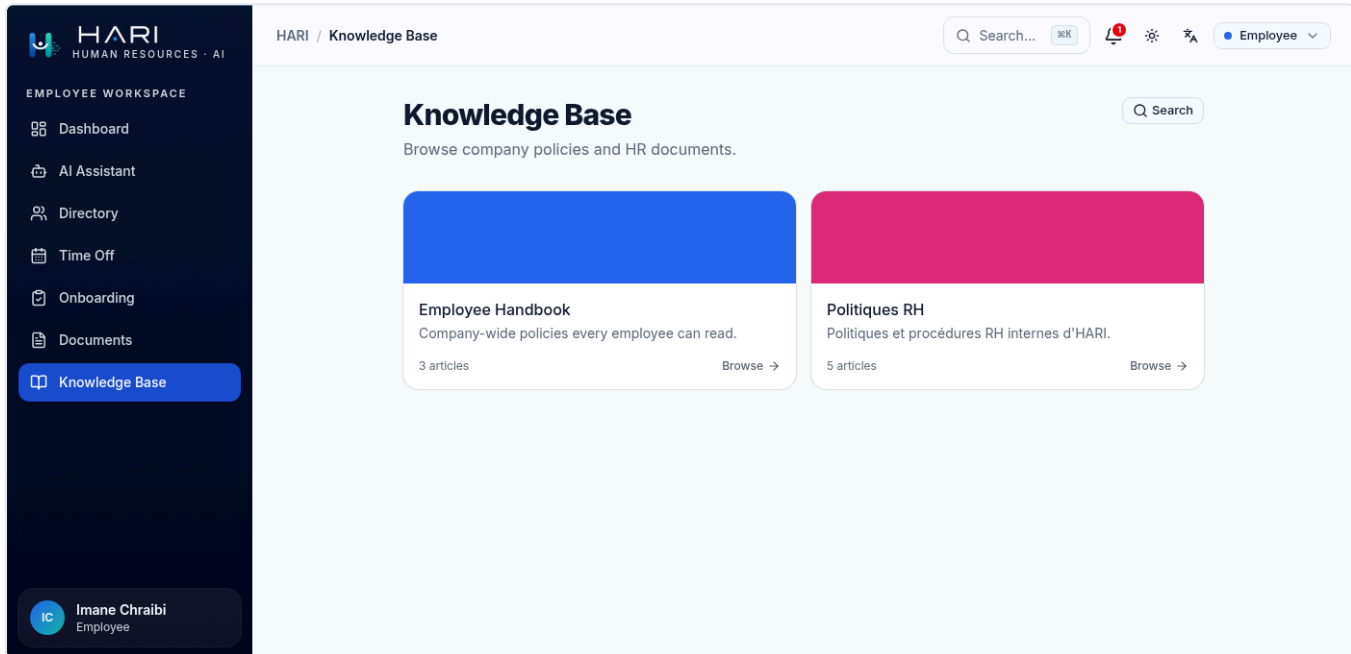
Tier	Employee	Manager	HR Admin	Super Admin
All employees	yes	yes	yes	yes
Managers & above	no	yes	yes	yes
HR only	no	no	yes	yes

A document is readable when its tier is in the reader's list **and** it is published. Both halves matter, and the second one is easy to forget: the seed ships a draft (*Relocation Policy*) that no reader of any role can open, because drafts are never published and never indexed.

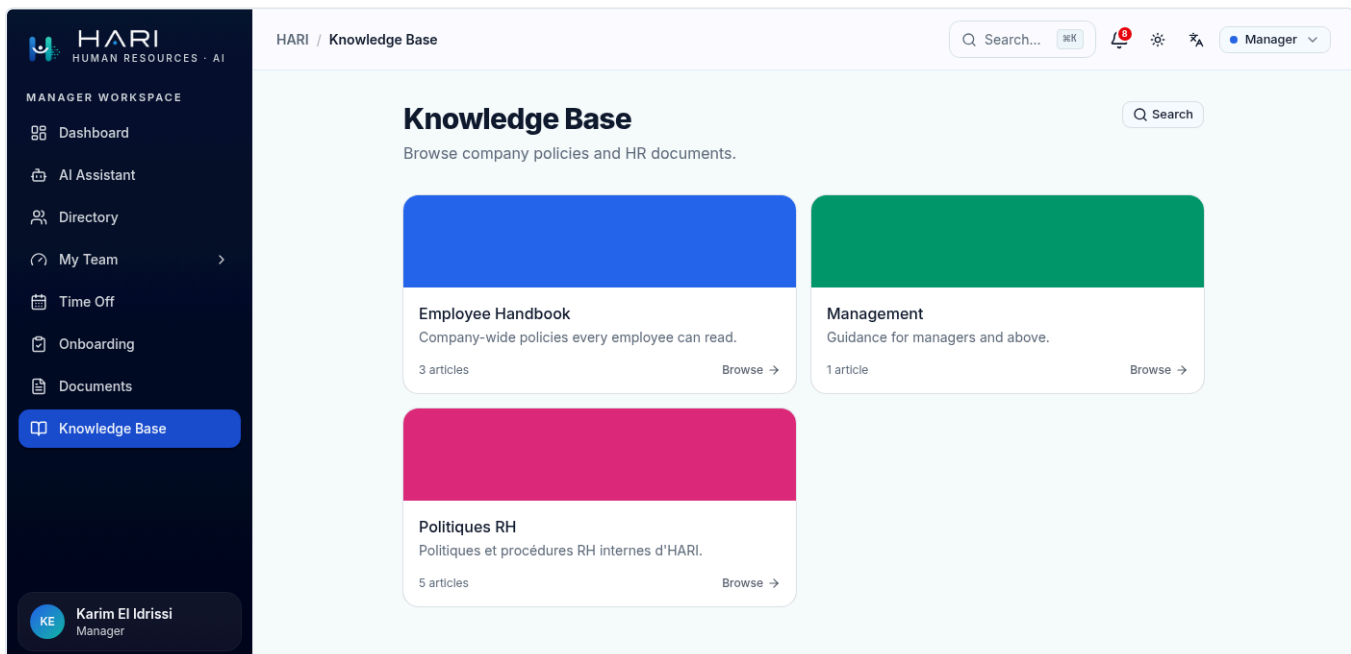
What a role sees

The same URL, `/kb`, signed in as three different people. The collection grid is not filtered in the browser; collections with nothing visible are never sent.

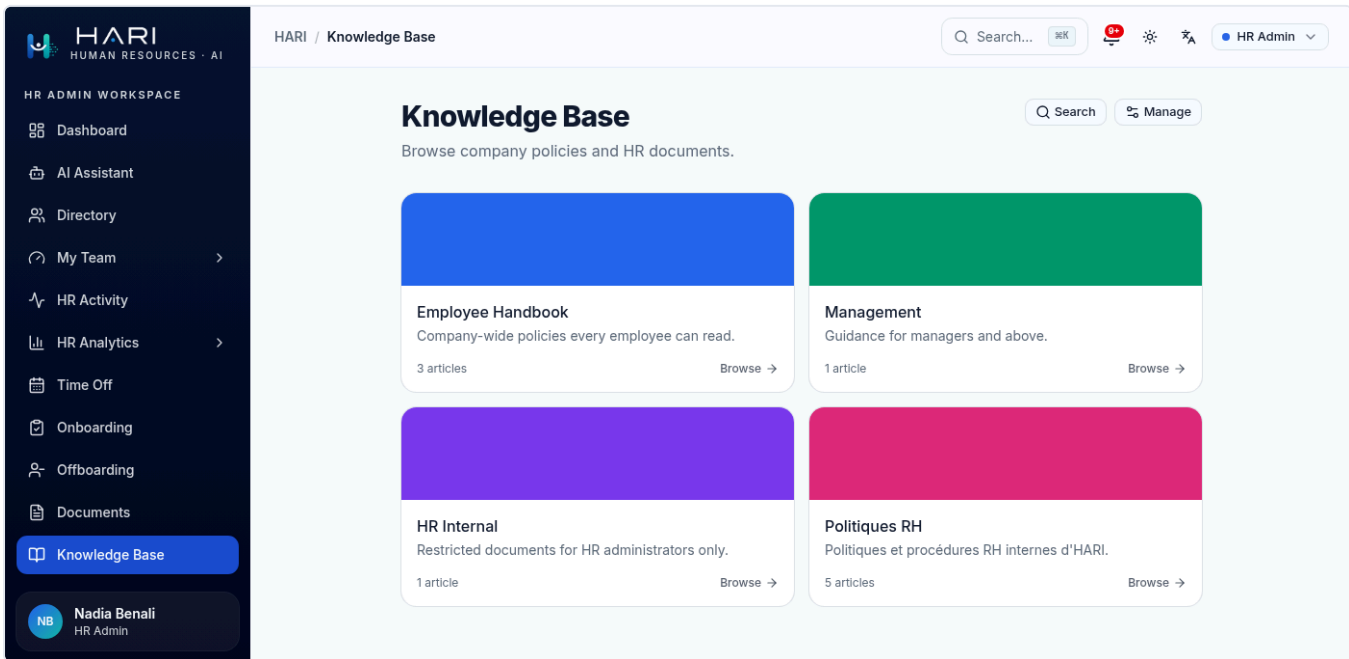
Employee (Imane Chraibi) sees two collections, eight articles, and no management controls.



Manager (Karim El Idrissi) sees the same two, plus *Management*.



HR Admin (Nadia Benali) sees all four, and gains a *Manage* button next to *Search*.



Restricted content is invisible, not forbidden

Knowing that a document exists is itself a leak. A restricted URL therefore returns an ordinary 404 rather than a "denied" page, so a guessed address cannot be used to probe for content. Not-found, unpublished, and above-your-tier are deliberately indistinguishable.

/kb/management as an Employee returns 404. As a Manager, the same URL returns the collection, and the article carries a *Managers & above* badge.

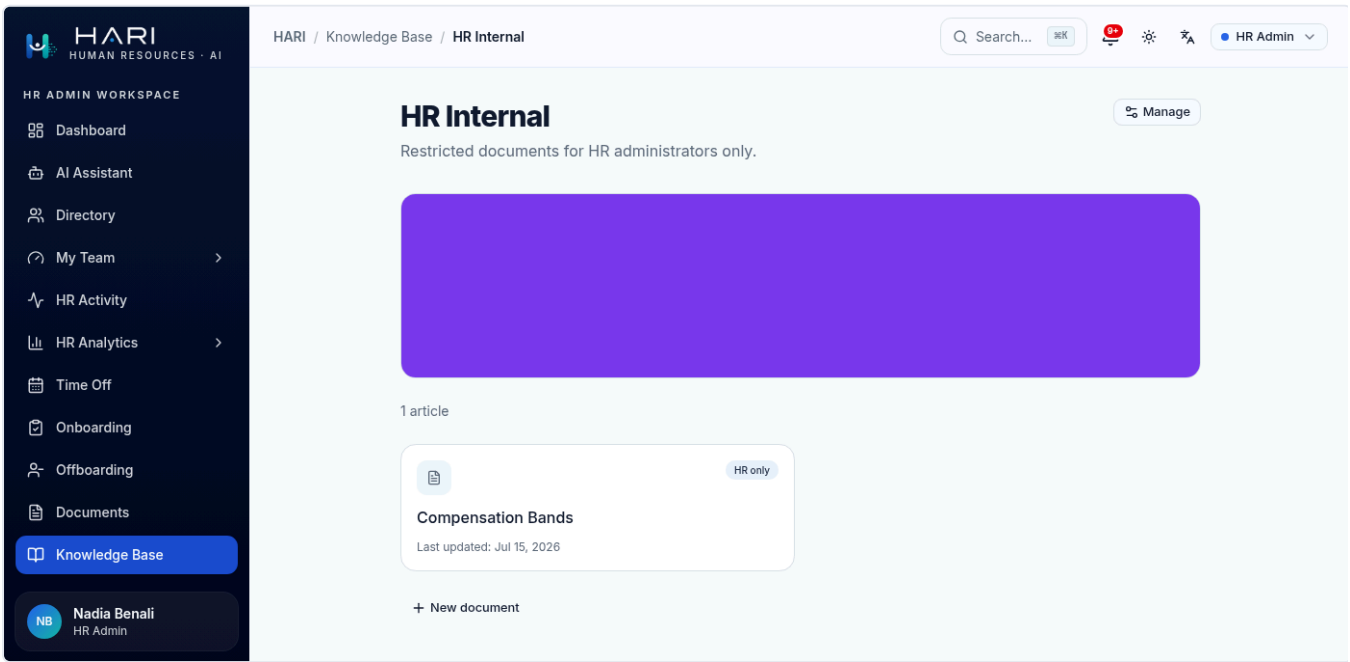
The screenshot shows the HARI Employee Workspace. The left sidebar contains a menu with options: Dashboard, AI Assistant, Directory, Time Off, Onboarding, Documents, and Knowledge Base (highlighted). The top header shows the HARI logo, the path 'HARI / Knowledge Base / Management', a search bar, and a user profile dropdown set to 'Employee'. The main content area displays a 404 error message: '404 | This page could not be found.' The user profile at the bottom left is for Imane Chraibi, an Employee.

Employee: the collection does not exist, as far as this account can tell.

The screenshot shows the HARI Manager Workspace. The left sidebar contains a menu with options: Dashboard, AI Assistant, Directory, My Team, Time Off, Onboarding, Documents, and Knowledge Base (highlighted). The top header shows the HARI logo, the path 'HARI / Knowledge Base / Management', a search bar, and a user profile dropdown set to 'Manager'. The main content area displays the 'Management' page with the subtitle 'Guidance for managers and above.' Below this is a large green rectangular placeholder. Underneath, it says '1 article' and shows a card for 'Manager Playbook' with a 'Managers & above' badge and the text 'Last updated: Jul 15, 2026'. The user profile at the bottom left is for Karim El Idrissi, a Manager.

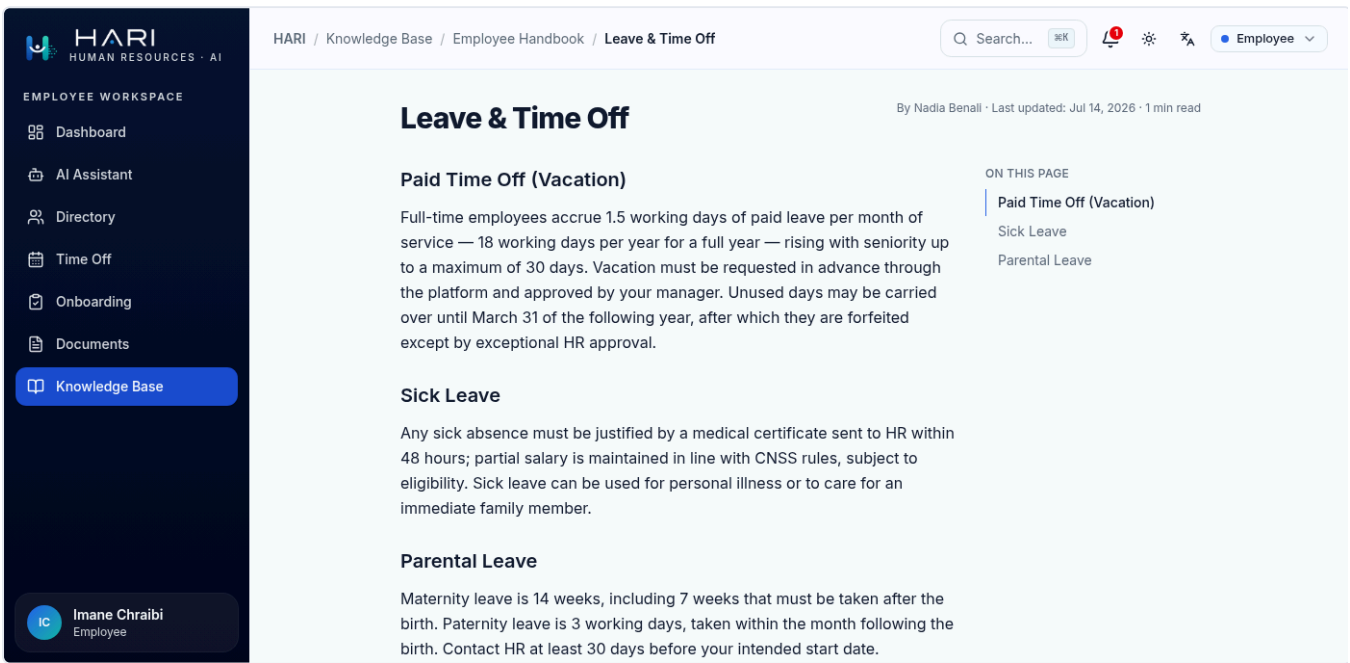
Manager: the same URL, now readable and tier-badged.

Badges only appear above the default tier, so an Employee never sees one at all. HR Admin sees the *HR only* badge on *Compensation Bands*, in the collection a Manager cannot open.



Reading an article

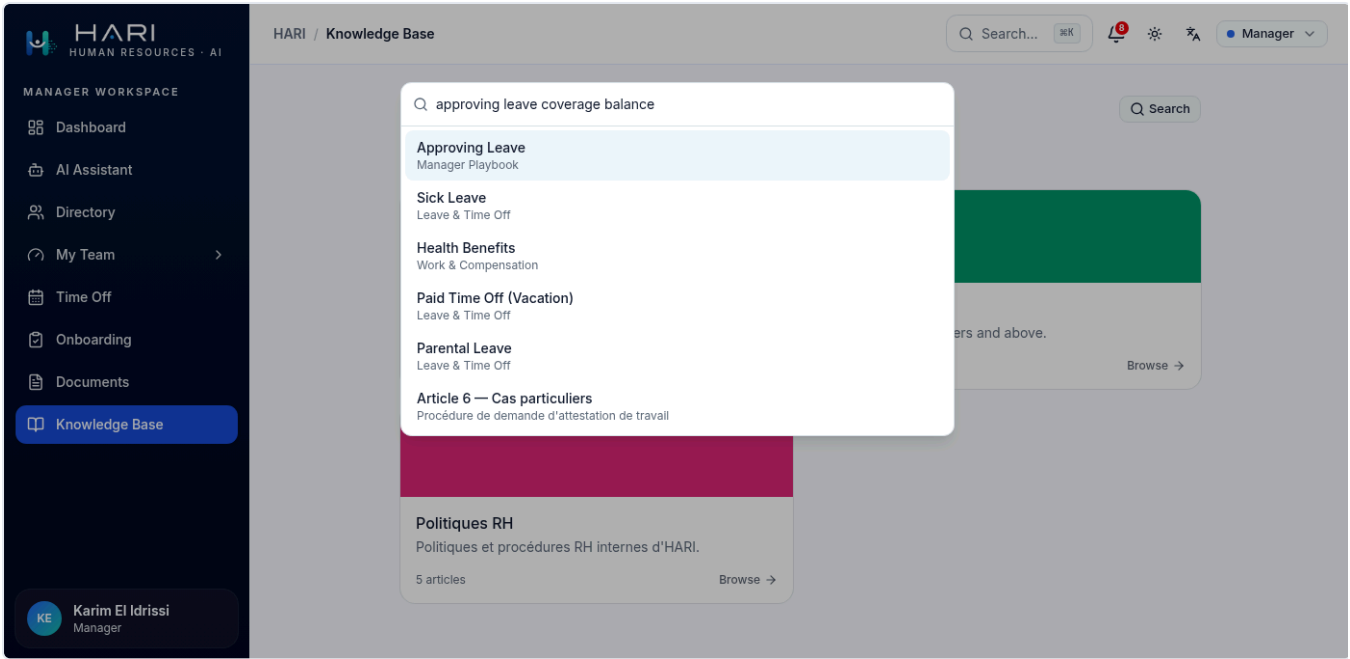
The reader shows the title, author, last-updated date, reading time, and a table of contents built from the article's own headings. Those headings are also the anchors the assistant cites, which is what lets a chat answer link to an exact section rather than to the page.



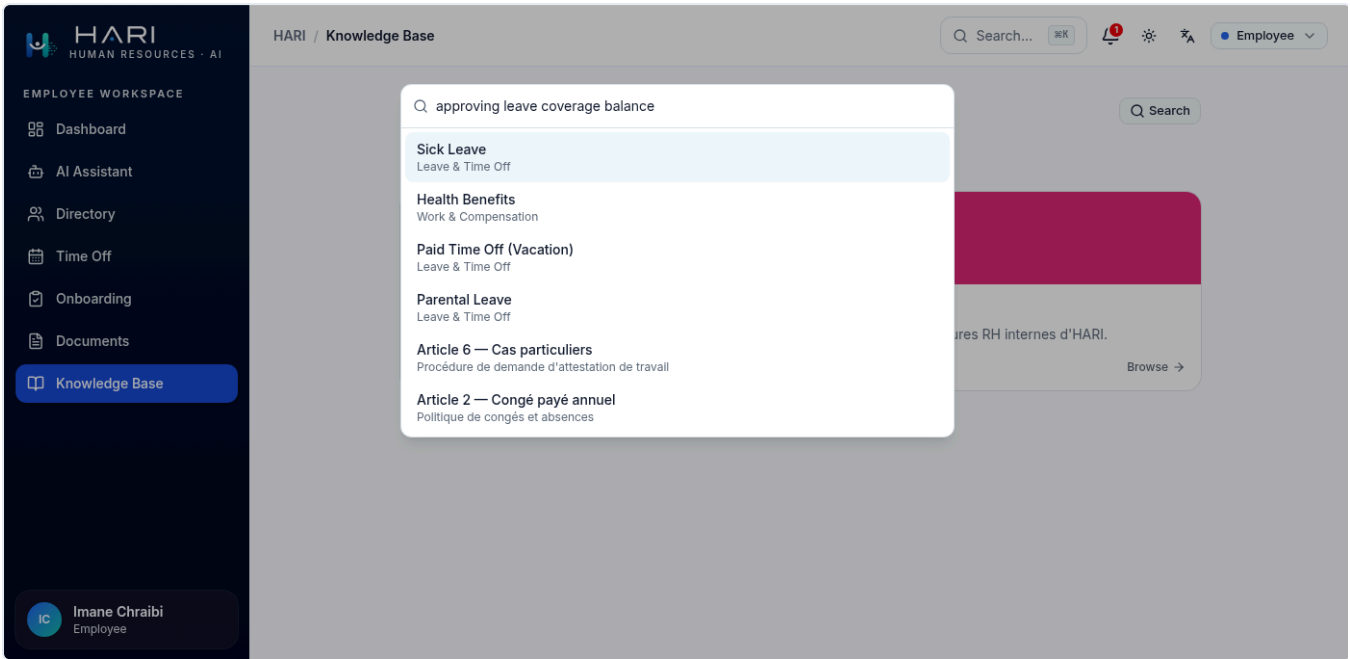
Search is gated by the same rule

Search is not a keyword filter over what the page already loaded. It runs the retrieval query on the server, scoped to the caller, and returns section-level hits that link straight to an anchor.

The clearest way to see the tier gate is to run one query as two roles. Both searched approving leave coverage balance. The Manager's top hit is Approving Leave from the Manager Playbook. The Employee's list is the same list with that row removed, and everything below it ranked identically. There is no placeholder and no "restricted" message, because the row was never a candidate.



Manager: Approving Leave, from the Manager Playbook, ranks first.



Employee: the same query, the same ranking, that first row absent.

Managing the library

`Manage` is gated on `kb:manage`, which HR Admin and Super Admin hold. The admin table is the only place where the library is visible in full: every status, every tier, including the seeded draft that no reader can reach.

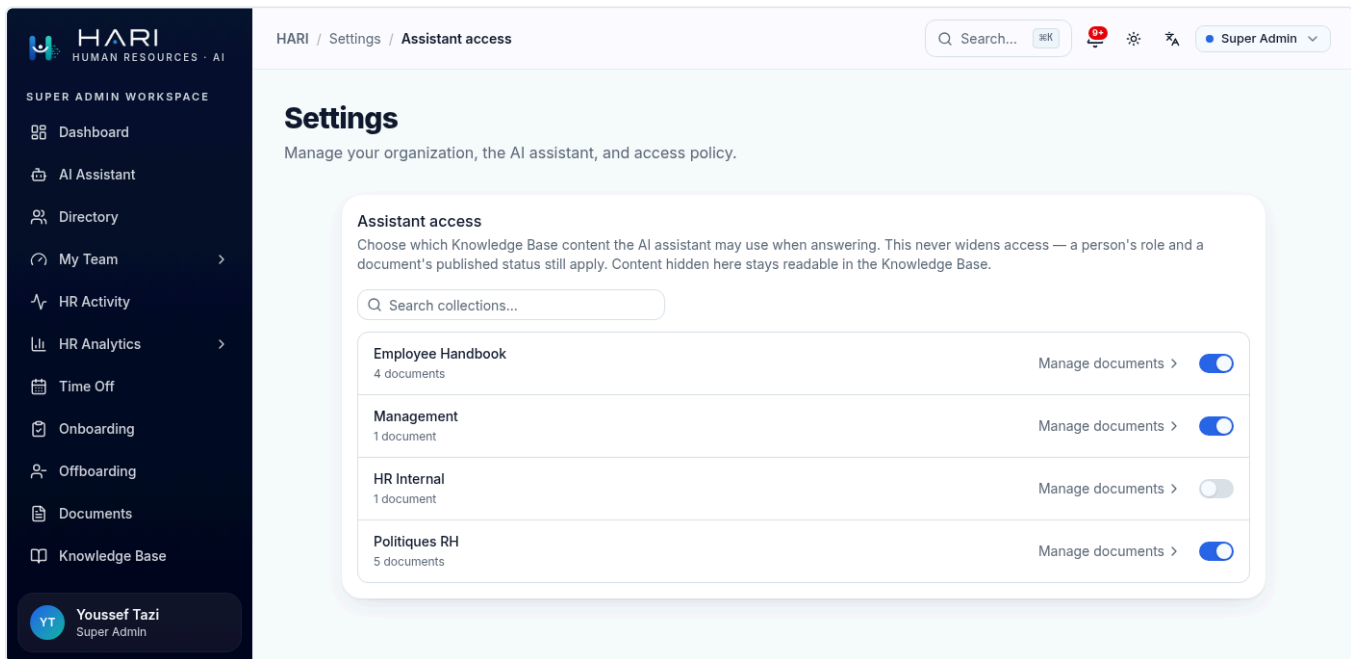
The screenshot shows the 'Manage Knowledge Base' interface within the HARI HR Admin Workspace. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Dashboard, AI Assistant, Directory, My Team, HR Activity, HR Analytics, Time Off, Onboarding, Offboarding, Documents, and Knowledge Base (highlighted). The main content area has a breadcrumb 'HARI / Knowledge Base / Admin' and a search bar. The title 'Manage Knowledge Base' is followed by the subtitle 'Create, edit, publish and archive HR documents and collections.' Below this is a 'Documents' section with a '+ New document' button and filter options: 'Filter by title...', 'All statuses', 'All collections', 'Recently updated', 'Apply', and 'Clear'. A table lists documents with columns: Name, Collection, Status, Access level, Updated by, Views, and Actions. The table contains 8 rows of data, including 'Compensation Bands', 'Manager Playbook', 'Relocation Policy (draft)', 'Leave & Time Off', 'Politique de confidentialité et sécurité des données RH', 'Guide d'intégration (onboarding)', and 'Procédure de demande d'attestation de travail'. The user profile 'Nadia Benali HR Admin' is visible in the bottom left.

Name	Collection	Status	Access level	Updated by	Views	Actions
Compensation Bands	HR Internal	Published	HR only	Nadia Benali	0	...
Manager Playbook	Management	Published	Managers & above	Nadia Benali	0	...
Relocation Policy (draft)	Employee Handbook	Draft	All employees	Youssef Tazi	0	...
Leave & Time Off	Employee Handbook	Published	All employees	Nadia Benali	4	...
Politique de confidentialité et sécurité des données RH	Politiques RH	Published	All employees	Nadia Benali	0	...
Guide d'intégration (onboarding)	Politiques RH	Published	All employees	Nadia Benali	0	...
Procédure de demande d'attestation de travail	Politiques RH	Published	All employees	Nadia Benali	3	...

Documents are always created as drafts. Publishing is what splits the content into chunks, embeds them, and makes them retrievable; unpublishing or archiving deletes those chunks again. A draft has no chunks at all, so content that is not ready cannot reach the assistant even by accident.

Deciding what the assistant may use

This is the one Knowledge Base capability that belongs to Super Admin alone, behind `admin:settings`. It answers a narrow question: of the content a person may already read, what may the AI use when answering?



The seed ships *HR Internal* switched off to demonstrate this. The policy only ever takes access away. Role and published status are applied first and are not negotiable here, so switching a collection on cannot show anyone something their tier forbids; the switch can only narrow what the assistant may draw on. Content hidden here stays readable in the Knowledge Base, and stays findable by its search, because the policy governs the assistant rather than the reader.

Where the rules actually live

Worth being precise about, since it is the reason the demonstrations above hold rather than merely appearing to.

The tier gate is part of the database query, not an instruction in a prompt and not a filter in the browser. Retrieval is hybrid: a vector search over `pgvector` and a Postgres full-text search, fused by reciprocal rank fusion, with the caller's tier list and the published status applied as SQL conditions inside both halves. The reader, the search box, and the assistant all enter through that one query. This is why the chatbot cannot answer from a document the reader would refuse to show: not because it has been told not to, but because those rows never come back.

Citations are built server-side from the database. The model receives numbered references and emits `[1]`, and the link is assembled from the stored collection, article, and anchor. A citation therefore cannot point at a document that was not retrieved.

For the schema, the retrieval SQL, and the enforcement contract, see [docs/architecture/knowledge-base.md](#) and [docs/architecture/authorization-invariants.md](#). The role and permission definitions themselves are in `src/lib/rbac.ts`.

Reproducing this

Sign in with any demo account at `/login` (all use `password123`) and compare `/kb`:

Account	Role	Collections
<code>collaborateur@hari.ma</code>	Employee	2
<code>manager@hari.ma</code>	Manager	3
<code>rh@hari.ma</code>	HR Admin	4
<code>admin@hari.ma</code>	Super Admin	4

Then visit `/kb/management` as the first two accounts to see the 404, and search `approving leave coverage balance` as each to watch the result list change.